MILITARY SPECIFICATION

ASPIRIN, CAFFEINE AND PHENACETIN TABLETS

This specification is approved for use by the Defense Personnel Support Center, Defense Logistics Agency, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers Aspirin, Caffeine and Phenacetin Tablets (see 6.2).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-C-186 - Containers, Packaging and Packing for Drugs, Chemicals and Pharmaceuticals.

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-140 - Tablets (for Medicinal Purposes).

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Defense Personnel Support Center, Directorate of Medical Materiel, DPSC-ATT, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 6505

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(Copies of specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply.

U. S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH, EDUCATION, AND WELFARE,
FOOD AND DRUG ADMINISTRATION (FDA)

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Food and Drug Administration, Washington, DC 20204.)

U. S. PHARMACOPEIAL CONVENTION, INC.

The United States Pharmacopeia (USP).

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA 18042.)

The National Formulary (NF).

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA 18042.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Shall be Aspirin, Caffeine and Phenacetin Tablets, and shall be in accordance with all applicable requirements of FED-STD-140, and as specified herein.

S2. Classification. Shall be type I.

S5.3 The following is added to this paragraph:

Shall be tablets containing 227 mg of aspirin, 32 mg of caffeine, and 162 mg of phenacetin per tablet, within the applicable assay limits for the tablets.

Shall be in accordance with the tests, standards, and requirements of NF XIII, which was official from 1 September 1970 to 1 July 1975.

As an alternate to the assay procedures contained in NF XIII, the tablets shall be assayed for aspirin, phenacetin, and caffeine as specified in 4.5.1.1.

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3.2 Ingredients.

3.2.1 Aspirin and caffeine. The aspirin and caffeine used in the manufacture of the tablets shall comply with the tests, standards, and requirements of the USP, including any supplements or revisions thereto.

3.2.2 Phenacetin. The phenacetin used in the manufacture of the tablets shall comply with the tests, standards, and requirements of the USP XVIII, which was official from 1 September 1970 to 1 July 1975.

3.3 Other ingredients. All other ingredients used in the manufacture of the tablets shall comply with S5.1 of FED-STD-140.

3.4 Expiration dating period. The expiration dating period shall be not less than 36 months.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Supplier responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and, (i) as to any expiration dated item, for the expiration dating period specified by the contractor for such item, or such longer period as may be required by regulation of any federal agency; or (ii) as to non-dated items, for not less than 3 years after delivery of the item to the Government.

4.1.2 No company supplying any ingredient(s) to the contractor will be considered an acceptable facility for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein.

4.2 Sampling. Sampling as shown in FED-STD-140 shall be applicable.

4.3 Packaging inspection. The inspection of the intermediate package, packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

4.4 Labeling inspection. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and the unit of product shall be the unit of issue. The inspection lot shall be the number of units of issue of each batch, lot, control number, etc., offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level for labeling shall be S-2 and the acceptance number shall be zero.

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4.5 Tests and examinations. Tests and examinations shall be performed to determine compliance with all requirements of this document and all referenced documents.

4.5.1 Tests.

4.5.1.1 Assay for Aspirin, Phenacetin, and Caffeine.

Equipment:

Suitable IR spectrophotometer with a 0.1 mm cell.

Procedure:

Standard Preparation:

Accurately weigh the exact quantities of the following reference standards: 324 mg of phenacetin reference standard, 454 mg of aspirin reference standard, and 64 mg of caffeine reference standard. Transfer the standards to a glass-stoppered 50 ml conical flask and add 30.0 ml of chloroform, A.R.

Sample Preparation:

Select 10 tablets at random, weigh them, and calculate the average tablet weight. Reduce the tablets to a fine powder and transfer an accurately weighed sample equivalent to about one tablet to a glass-stoppered 50 ml conical flask and add 15.0 ml of chloroform, A.R.

Shake each of the standard and sample preparations vigorously for 10 minutes and filter the chloroform solution through chloroform washed and dried filter paper. (A suitable method to prevent loss of chloroform during filtration is to withdraw the chloroform solution into a syringe which has been fitted with a filter paper between the syringe tip and needle.)

Use chloroform reagent as the blank preparation and record the absorbances of the standard preparation, sample preparation, and blank preparation, respectively, in a 0.1 mm cell from 5.50 to 6.70 microns in the infrared spectrophotometer.

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CALCULATIONS:

Calculate the phenacetin content (P), expressed in mg per tablet, from the formula:

$$P = \left[(Ap-Ab)/(As-Ab)\right] \times \frac{\left[Stp(Wa/Wt)\right]}{2}$$

where,

Ap = Absorbance of sample preparation at 6.63 microns
As = Absorbance of standard preparation at 6.63 microns
Ab = Absorbance of blank preparation at 6.63 microns
Wa = Average weight per tablet (in mg)
Wt = Sample weight (in mg)
Stp = Weight of the phenacetin reference standard (in mg)

$$\frac{P}{162\ mg} \times 100\ percent = percent\ of\ required\ amount\ of\ phenacetin$$

Calculate the aspirin content (R), expressed in mg per tablet, from the formula:

$$R = \left[(Aa-Ab)/(As-Ab)\right] \times \frac{\left[Sta\ (Wa/Wt)\right]}{2}$$

where,

Aa = Absorbance of sample preparation at 5.70 microns
As = Absorbance of standard preparation at 5.70 microns
Ab = Absorbance of blank preparation at 5.70 microns
Wa = Average weight per tablet (in mg)
Wt = Sample weight (in mg) .
Sta = Weight of aspirin reference standard (in mg)

$$\frac{R}{227\ mg} \times 100\ percent = percent\ of\ required\ amount\ of\ aspirin$$

Calculate the caffeine content (C), expressed in mg per tablet, from the formula:

$$C = \left[(Ac-Ab-Kp1-Ka1)/(As-Ab-Kp2-Ka2)\right] \times \frac{\left[Stc(Wa/Wt)\right]}{2}$$

where,

Ac = Absorbance of sample preparation at 6.05 microns
As = Absorbance of standard preparation at 6.05 microns
Ab = Absorbance of blank preparation at 6.05 microns
Wa = Average weight per tablet (in mg)
Wt = Sample weight (in mg)
Stc = Weight of the caffeine reference standard (in mg)

$$\frac{C}{32\ mg} \times 100\ percent = percent\ of\ required\ amount\ of\ caffeine$$

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Kp 1 and Kp 2 = Correction factors for phenacetin interference at 6.05 microns - one of the sample preparation and the other of the standard preparation, respectively, calculated from the formulas:

$$Kp\ 1 = \left[0.083^{1/} \times \left(\frac{P}{162}\right)\right]$$

$$Kp\ 2 = \left[0.083^{1/} \times \left(\frac{Stp}{324}\right)\right]$$

Ka 1 and Ka 2 = Correction factors for aspirin interference at 6.05 microns - one of the sample preparation and the other of the standard preparation, respectively, calculated from the formulas:

$$Ka\ 1 = \left[0.037^{1/} \times \left(\frac{R}{227}\right)\right]$$

$$Ka\ 2 = \left[0.037^{1/} \times \left(\frac{Sta}{454}\right)\right]$$

1/ These factors used in the calculation of Kp and Ka values are calculated by preparing standard mixtures in which the concentration of the phenacetin or the aspirin is varied by about ± 5 percent while the other ingredients are held constant.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging requirements. The requirements for packaging shall be in accordance with all applicable requirements of PPP-C-186, and as specified herein.

5.2 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Unit of issue. One bottle containing 1000 tablets, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.2.2 Level A.

5.2.2.1 Immediate container. The immediate container shall be a commercially available immediate container considered acceptable by the Food and Drug Administration (FDA) for the product contained therein and shall be of such compatibility that neither the contents nor the container are altered in any way by each other.

5.2.2.2 Unit package. At the option of the contractor, a unit package may be furnished for each bottle. If a unit package is furnished, each bottle shall be packaged as specified in 5.2.5 of PPP-C-186.

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5.2.2.3 Intermediate package. Twelve units shall be packaged as specified in 5.2.9 of PPP-C-186.

5.2.3 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.3 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.3.1 Level A. Two intermediate packages (24 units) shall be packed in an exterior container as specified in 5.4.4 of PPP-C-186.

5.3.2 Level B. Two intermediate packages (24 units) shall be packed in an exterior container as specified in 5.4.3.2 of PPP-C-186.

5.3.3 Level C. The packaged tablets shall be packed in shipping containers in a manner that will afford adequate protection against damage during direct shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. These packs shall conform to the carrier's rules and regulations.

5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 Labeling. Labeling shall be in accordance with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and shall include the information required below:

5.4.1.1 Immediate container. Each immediate container label shall bear the following information:

(a) label information in accordance with commercial practice.
(b) the expiration date.

5.4.1.2 Unit package. Each unit package label shall bear the following information:

(a) label information in accordance with commercial practice.
(b) the National Stock Number.

NOTES: (1) The National Stock Number need not be preceded by any prefix.
(2) Strip labeling may be used.
(3) Label adhesion test shall not apply.
(4) If a unit package is not supplied, the National Stock Number shall appear on the immediate container label.

5.4.2 Intermediate package. Each intermediate package shall be marked as specified in 5.5.3 of PPP-C-186. In addition, type I shelf life markings as specified in MIL-STD-129 shall be shown.

5.4.3 Exterior container. Exterior containers shall be marked as specified in 5.5.4 of PPP-C-186. Type I shelf life markings as specified in MIL-STD-129 shall also be shown.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) National Stock Number.
(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.2 and 5.3).

6.2 This specification covers the following item:

National Stock Number	Item Identification
6505-00-100-6245	ASPIRIN, CAFFEINE AND PHENACETIN TABLETS, 1000s

Preparing activity:
DLA - DM

Project No. 6505-1772

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER *(Number)* AND TITLE
MIL-A-37626(DLA-DM) ASPIRIN, CAFFEINE AND PHENACETIN TABLETS

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS OF SUBMITTER

☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER

1. ☐ HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE? ☐ IS ANY PART OF IT TOO RIGID, RESTRICTIVE, LOOSE OR AMBIGUOUS? PLEASE EXPLAIN BELOW.

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B. RECOMMENDED WORDING CHANGE

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